Gmail

Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com>

Apologies, Next Steps, and Request for Information

1 message

Stephen Cooke <stephencooke.c@gmail.com> Wed, Oct 16, 2024 at 1:36 PM
To: JLM Admin <admin@jlmfamilylawyers.com.au>, Anna Roberts <aroberts@delaneyroberts.com.au>

Dear Jo and Anna,

I hope this message finds you well.

Firstly, I want to extend my sincere apologies for any confusion or frustration caused yesterday. I greatly appreciate your patience throughout this process. Jo, I would be especially grateful for any advice you may have regarding the next steps or recommendations on providing information or answering any questions you may have for me.

I understand that there have been some challenges from your perspective, particularly with my adherence to due process. This is not entirely intentional on my part. Please feel free to reach out with any questions or requests, with Anna in copy, especially concerning the boys when they are with me, including if you'd like any photos or updates.

As I am now self-represented, I hope I'm not overstepping by asking: Would it be possible for you to share, at a high level, what information you've received or reviewed so far (for example, school records, OOSH, etc.)? I would like to provide additional context to help you and Drew form a more complete picture, while fully respecting Heather's privacy and her time with the boys. My intention is not to inquire into specifics of the boys' activities while they are with Heather but rather to understand how such information is generally communicated (e.g., through email, affidavit, or otherwise). This will help ensure I am following the appropriate process and contributing effectively from my side.

I also kindly ask you both to take note of my service address:

- **PO Box 33, SHORTLAND, NSW 2307**
- **Phone**: 0412846712
- **Email**: stephencooke.c@gmail.com

And my residential address:

- **7A Bakeri Cct, Warabrook, NSW 2304**

To make it clear, any perceived reluctance on my part to proceed with Drew or the Family Report during yesterday's mention has nothing to do with impeding the court's process or pursuing what's in the best interests of Christian and Joshua. What I've become very aware of is the importance of adhering to due process, respecting it, and recognizing the consequences when it's not fully realized, as this can have significant implications. My hesitation yesterday was solely about ensuring I get the necessary information in front of Drew in a way that allows him to action it as he deems fit. I actually quite like Drew and think he is a lovely man based on my limited interaction with him. I am confident he will act in the best interests of the boys.

Lastly, I want to address a personal matter to clarify any potential misunderstandings. Since the end of my marriage, I have remained celibate. I understand that

this may not seem directly relevant, but I believe it's important to state this to avoid any false assumptions or misconceptions that could affect the overall process, which should be addressed in court should it come to that. My choice is not because I hope or expect the marriage is salvageable, but rather it reflects where I am personally. Additionally, I want to emphasize that I do not drink alcohol, except at social work functions, and this has remained consistent throughout the process. As noted in the attached report, my alcohol levels remain below detectable limits, and I have fully complied with the order regarding refraining from alcohol consumption when the children are under my care.

As you are aware, I am working towards a 50/50 equal parenting arrangement for the boys. I firmly believe that, with the appropriate structure and conditions in place on both sides, the boys would benefit the most from this arrangement. I would greatly appreciate any support or guidance from you, Jo, Drew, and Anna, to help us reach this outcome in the best interests of the boys.

In addition, I would like to suggest exploring a neutral third-party therapy option specifically aimed at improving co-parenting communication and collaboration. Heather and I could attend independently and, where appropriate, jointly. I believe this could foster a healthier environment for addressing co-parenting issues, and I would welcome any recommendations you may have for suitable services that focus on co-parenting.

Without prejudice, Heather has mentioned concerns about being audio recorded. To address this, I propose that we either seek an order or mutual undertaking that prohibits either Heather or myself from audio recording conversations between the two of us or between the children and the other parent while under the care of the other parent, without explicit consent. I rely upon you, Anna, for guidance in this regard as to how such an order or mutual undertaking could be introduced and applied in an unbiased, neutral, and equal fashion. I believe this would help ease her concerns and foster a more neutral, cooperative environment.

On this note, Anna, could you please assist in preparing and serving the necessary subpoenas to the parties listed below, for which I have been granted leave, in relation to the Family Report that Drew is working on? Additionally, could you provide me with an estimate of your costs for handling these subpoenas and a timeline for when I can expect the documents to be returned? I would ask that you request a 7-day turnaround time and copy me on such correspondence. I will also need independent copies of the documents once they are available.

- **ATUNE Health Centres - Cardiff**
  Address: 52 Ada St, Cardiff NSW 2285
  Phone: (02) 4954 4511

- **Chromis Occupational Medicine**
  Address: 47 Church St, Maitland NSW 2320
  Phone: (02) 4936 9999

Thank you both again for your understanding and support.

Best regards,
Stephen

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